Moya Richards

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 10+ years of experience designing, developing, modernizing, and optimizing interactive web applications, enterprise platforms, cloud-native solutions, APIs, and distributed systems. Experienced building generative AI applications with Amazon Bedrock and SageMaker and translating emerging technologies, complex requirements, and open-ended problems into practical software experiences. Extensive experience building modern web experiences using TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, HTML, CSS, Python, and Node.js, with a strong focus on performance, usability, reusable architecture, and maintainable code. Proven ability to improve application performance, shape technical architecture, develop reusable solutions, resolve production issues, mentor engineers, and collaborate across engineering, product, design, data science, business, and customer-facing teams. Combines software engineering with a strong background in visual design and Adobe Creative Suite, bringing a unique understanding of the intersection between technology, creativity, user experience, and digital content creation.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Full-Stack Developer

Independent Software Consultant
Aug 2011 – Present

- Partner with organizations to gather requirements and design internal web applications that modernize business processes, improve customer engagement, and increase operational productivity.
- Design and develop database-driven applications and websites using Python, PHP, Java, React, JavaScript, TypeScript, MySQL, HTML, and CSS.
- Translate business requirements into maintainable technical solutions, application workflows, database structures, integrations, and user-facing functionality.
- Apply object-oriented programming, caching strategies, server administration, data modeling, and CRUD application patterns to build scalable and reliable systems.
- Design integrations between applications, databases, APIs, content management systems, and third-party services.
- Develop secure applications using OWASP web security practices to reduce vulnerabilities and protect customer, user, and organizational data.
- Create custom WordPress plugins, widgets, administrative tools, and CMS enhancements to support changing business and operational requirements.
- Troubleshoot application, integration, server, database, and configuration issues throughout the software development lifecycle.
- Communicate technical concepts, project status, risks, and recommendations to technical and nontechnical stakeholders.

Forward Deployed Engineer / Solution Developer

Amazon Web Services (AWS) | AWS Industries (AWSI), Prototyping and Customer Engineering (PACE)
Oct 2022 – Jul 2025

- Led the design and development of generative AI full-stack prototypes across Automotive, Energy, Financial Services, Healthcare and Life Sciences, Manufacturing and Supply Chain, and Telecommunications.

- Partnered with engineers, product teams, data scientists, industry specialists, and customer-facing stakeholders to define requirements, evaluate technical feasibility, refine application experiences, and deliver working solutions.
- Built modern web applications using React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, GraphQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, and Docker, integrating interactive frontend experiences with APIs, data platforms, distributed services, and generative AI capabilities.
- Integrated large language model capabilities using Amazon Bedrock, SageMaker, EC2, Lambda, S3, DynamoDB, API Gateway, and AppSync to transform business requirements and emerging AI technologies into functional user experiences and scalable, cloud-native applications.
- Designed and delivered production-oriented prototypes within highly ambiguous, time-boxed engagements, typically progressing from initial requirements to working applications within six weeks.
- Shaped application architecture, component design, API contracts, data flows, and user experiences when requirements and technical specifications were open-ended.
- Created reusable application and web components, engineering patterns, internal development tools, architecture documentation, and technical guidance to improve development speed and consistency across engineering teams.
- Mentored Developers and contributed to cross-team knowledge sharing, internal engineering tools, and reusable solution patterns to improve development efficiency and consistency across projects.
- Applied secure-by-design practices throughout the software development lifecycle, reviewing cloud architectures, application code, APIs, IAM controls, and infrastructure as code to identify, assess, prioritize, and support remediation of security risks before customer delivery.

Senior Software Developer

American Marketing Association
May 2021 – Oct 2022

- Architected and developed a serverless enterprise service bus using GraphQL and AWS serverless technologies to enable data exchange among Mailchimp, Salesforce, and WooCommerce.
- Designed event-driven and asynchronous workflows using Amazon SNS, SQS, S3, API Gateway, and AWS Lambda to support decoupled application communication and automated processing.
- Built and maintained APIs, backend services, data synchronization workflows, and third-party integrations supporting digital business operations.
- Reduced GraphQL API latency by 50% by implementing a DynamoDB-backed caching strategy that minimized Salesforce requests and improved application responsiveness.
- Developed a shell-based local development environment that automatically configured Docker containers, development tools, and test repositories, improving developer onboarding and setup consistency.
- Troubleshoot application integrations, data synchronization, performance, and environment configuration issues across internal and external systems.
- Managed digital content workflows for conferences and webinars, ensuring accurate metadata, content sequencing, and sponsor visibility across online platforms.
- Collaborated with business, marketing, technical, and external platform stakeholders to gather requirements, coordinate integrations, and resolve system issues.

Senior Full-Stack Developer

Safco Dental Supply LLC.
Apr 2013 – Feb 2021

- Led the design, development, integration, and maintenance of enterprise applications supporting ecommerce, customer service, accounting, warehouse operations, marketing, and internal business processes.
- Optimized the architecture and performance of a B2B ecommerce platform responsible for approximately 79% of company revenue.
- Designed and implemented integrations with PureClarity, Campaigner, Yotpo, Intercom, and other third-party platforms using APIs, webhooks, microservices, and Redis-backed message queues to support reliable data exchange and digital engagement.
- Led a website optimization initiative that included upgrading eight web servers, improving system performance by approximately 9%.
- Designed and developed more than 50 customized business applications, including an advertisement manager, dental-license validator, and PDF-generation tools for coupons, invoices, statements, transaction reports, sales records, purchase orders, credit memos, and regulatory documents.
- Improved employee productivity by approximately 90% by automating essential business workflows and replacing manual processes with custom applications.
- Developed applications managing more than 18,000 products and images while maintaining accurate product information and digital assets.
- Designed database schemas, application services, server environments, and infrastructure for customer-facing and internal applications, including separating workloads onto dedicated servers to reduce resource contention and improve reliability.
- Replaced proprietary software with open-source libraries, reducing recurring software licensing expenses.
- Partnered with vendors, business leaders, IT stakeholders, and departmental teams to evaluate technologies, define requirements, implement solutions, and resolve production application, integration, data, server, and performance issues.
- Provided technical direction and mentorship to developers in JavaScript, PHP, server architecture, data modeling, DevOps, secure development practices, and digital asset management.
- Trained more than 30 employees on new applications, tools, and workflows to improve adoption, productivity, and service quality.

Web Developer

City of Evanston
Sep 2012 – Apr 2013

- Developed CMS integrations using XML, JSON, and REST APIs while applying secure coding practices to protect information exchanged between applications and external services.
- Administered MySQL databases and completed domain mappings, website migrations, and database transfers while maintaining availability, data integrity, and secure access.
- Monitored web traffic and server activity to identify unusual access patterns, application usage trends, availability concerns, and potential security risks.
- Installed and maintained TLS certificates and website security controls to encrypt data in transit and restrict unauthorized access.
- Configured, maintained, and troubleshot Unix-based web servers supporting internet-facing applications.
- Resolved production availability, configuration, access, permissions, connectivity, and application issues.
- Managed user accounts, roles, permissions, and access privileges according to least-privilege principles.

- Diagnosed, repaired, upgraded, and maintained computer systems, operating systems, software, network connectivity, and VoIP equipment.

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, PHP, Java, HTML, CSS

Application Development: React, Next.js, Node.js, GraphQL, REST APIs, JSON, Object-Oriented Programming, CRUD Applications, WordPress

Cloud and Generative AI: Amazon Web Services, Amazon Bedrock, Amazon SageMaker, AWS Lambda, Amazon EC2, Amazon S3, Amazon DynamoDB, Amazon API Gateway, AWS AppSync, Amazon SNS, Amazon SQS, Large Language Models (LLMs)

Security: Secure Software Development Life Cycle, OWASP Practices, IAM Reviews, API Security, Architecture Security Reviews, TLS, Least-Privilege Access

Software Architecture: Distributed Systems, Event-Driven Architecture, Serverless Architecture, Service-Oriented Architecture, Microservices, API Integration, Enterprise Application Integration, Caching Strategies, Design Patterns

Databases and Data Technologies: PostgreSQL, MySQL, DB2, SQL, NoSQL, Redis, Data Modeling, Schema Design, Data Integration

Development and Operations: Docker, Linux/Unix, Bash and Shell Scripting, Server Administration, Application Monitoring, Production Troubleshooting, Infrastructure as Code

Methods and Leadership: Agile Development, Requirements Gathering, Feasibility Analysis, Technical Documentation, Stakeholder Management, Vendor Relations, Technical Mentoring, Cross-Functional Collaboration

Creative Technologies: Microsoft Office, Adobe Creative Suite, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe InDesign

EDUCATION

DeVry University

Bachelor of Science | Computer Information Systems | Chicago, IL

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate

Amazon Web Services

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP AND TECHNICAL WRITING

● Owner and administrator of a JavaScript-focused community with more than 94,000 members.

● Manage professional developer communities on Facebook and LinkedIn focused on programming, professional development, and technical knowledge sharing.

● Created Codingstorytime, an online community featuring programming exercises, quizzes, and educational development content.

● Publish software-development articles and technical content through Medium and DEV Community.

TECHNICAL WRITING

https://medium.com/@codingstorytime

https://dev.to/moyarich

COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

JavaScript focused group on Facebook

https://www.facebook.com/groups/alljavascript/

○ Technology focused group for professional developers on linkedI

https://www.linkedin.com/groups/13837299

○ Online community page for quizzes, exercises and programming stories

https://www.facebook.com/codingstorytime/

○ Technology focused group for professional developers on Facebook

https://www.facebook.com/groups/codingstorytime

CREATIVE TECHNOLOGY AND DESIGN

● Use Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, and InDesign for digital asset creation, branding, and UI-related design work.

● Apply both engineering and visual design perspectives to digital experiences and interfaces.

DESIGN PORTFOLIO

https://www.pinterest.com/moyarich/moya-card-designs